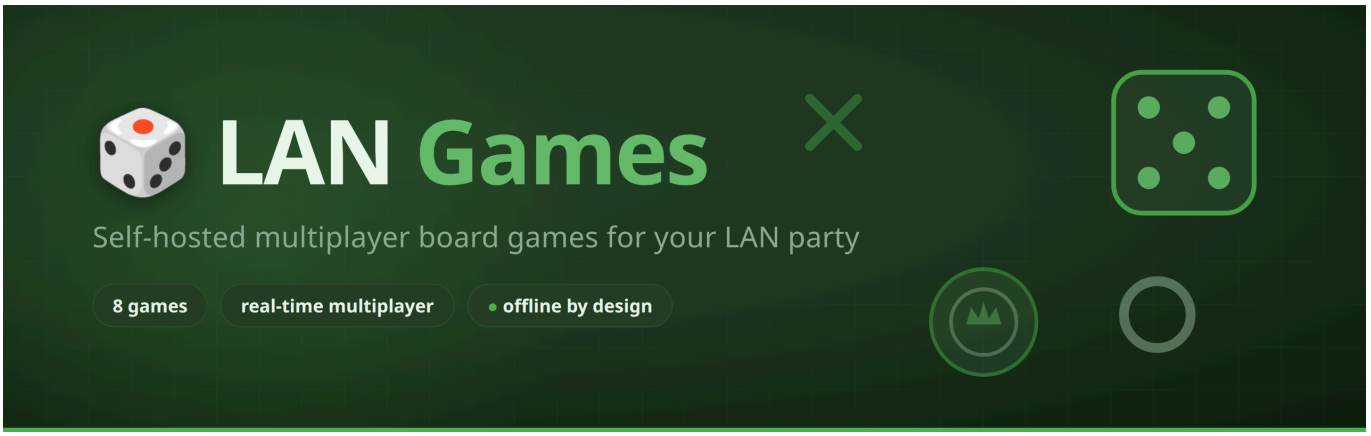
Lab 01: Build It. Connect It. Play.

IT1080C Computer Networking | Physical Networking Lab



Your first challenge is to deploy a local area network, configure your computer's IPv4 settings, and establish a connection to a locally hosted game server.

Important Rules

1. Use only the equipment assigned to your group.
2. **Do not** connect your lab network to UC_Secure or campus Ethernet outlets.
3. **Do not** modify switch configurations unless specifically instructed.
4. Keep cables organized and avoid unnecessary equipment disconnections.
5. Notify your TA or instructor if equipment is damaged or behaving unexpectedly.

What You'll Learn

Through deployment activities, you'll gain practical experience with:

- Ethernet connections and physical networking
- IPv4 addressing and subnet masks
- Communication between devices on a local network
- Basic networking commands (ping, arp)
- Locally hosted services

What You'll Accomplish

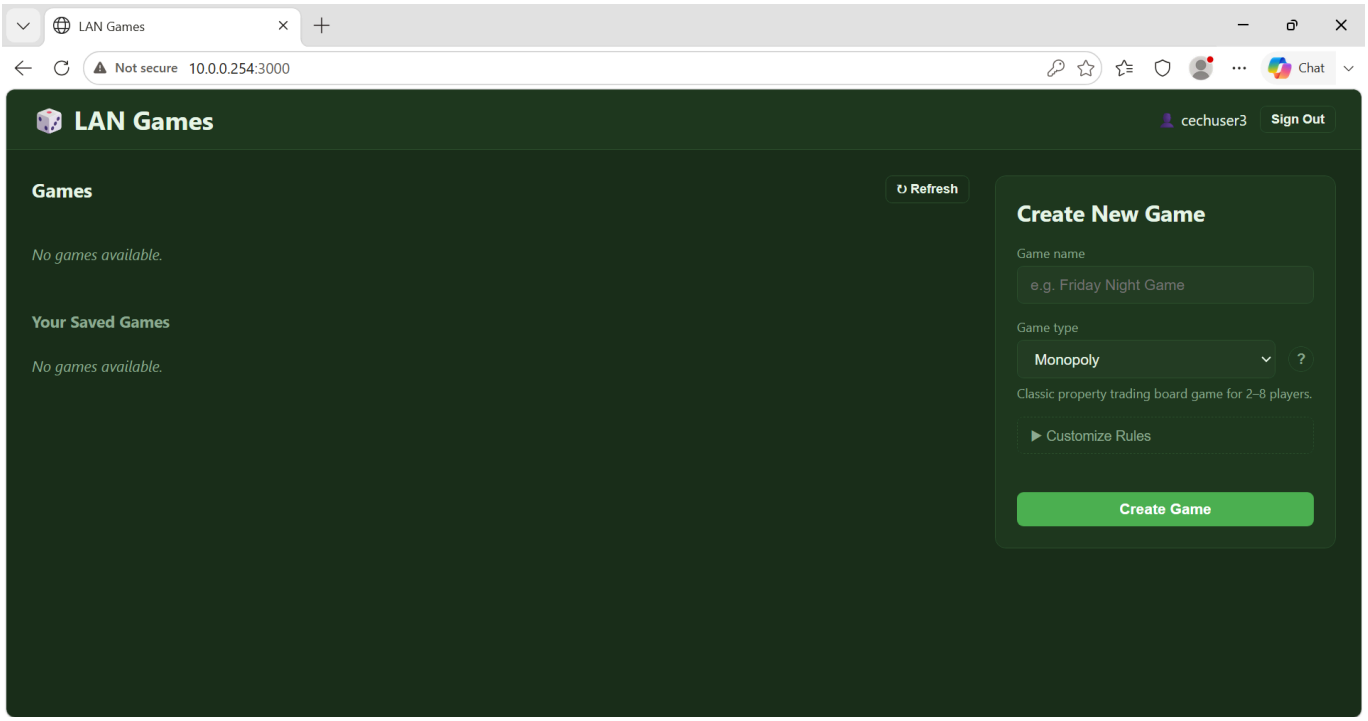
By the end of this lab, you should be able to:

- Identify and connect physical networking equipment.
- Configure a static IPv4 address and subnet mask.
- Establish communication with another device on the same LAN.
- Access a locally hosted web application.

The Challenge

Your mission is simple: **build a working network and use it to access a local game server.**

The games are hosted on a Raspberry Pi inside your deployment bag. To access them, you'll need to connect and configure your laptop. No Internet connection is required.



Part 1 - Get to Know Your Environment

Step 1: Identify Your Equipment

Before connecting anything, take a look at your deployment bag. If anything is missing, tell your TA or instructor **before** continuing.

Equipment	Purpose
Laptop	Your computer on the network
Switch	Connect devices on the LAN
Raspberry Pi	Host lan-games server
Ethernet Cables	Carry data between devices

Step 2: Log In

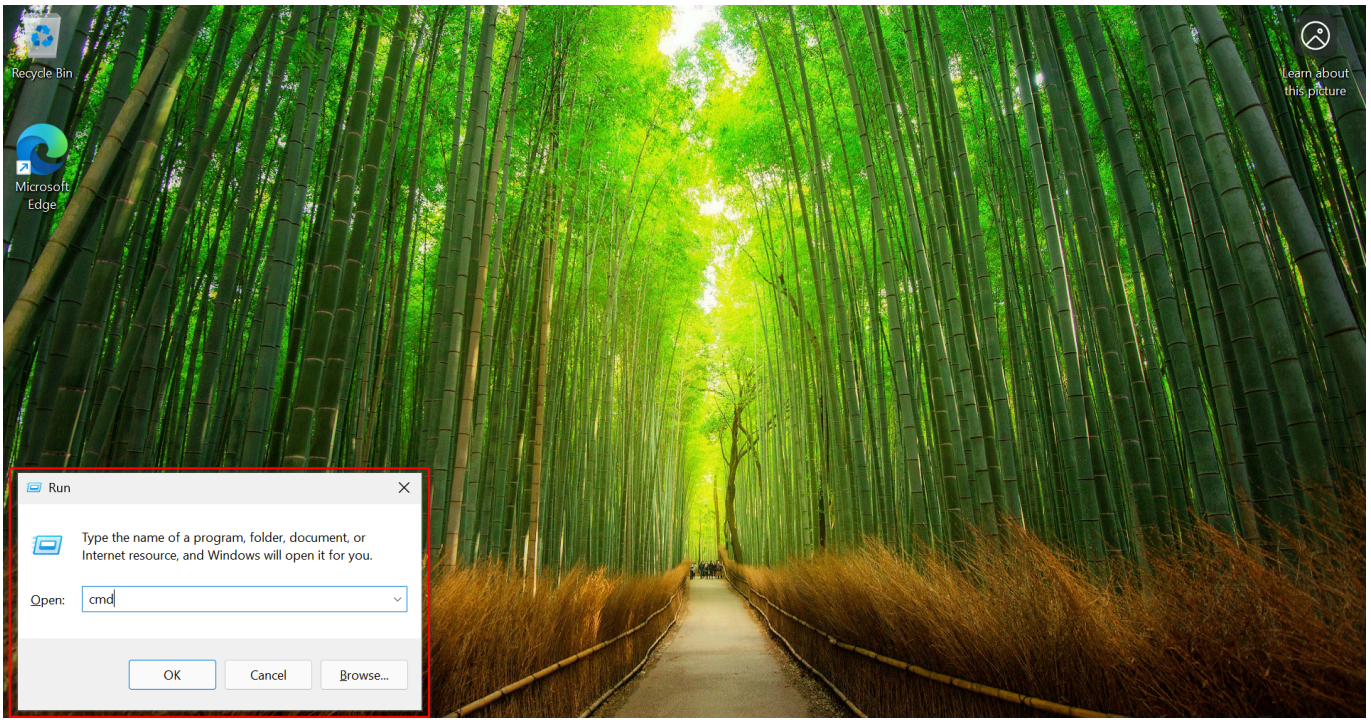
Turn on your assigned laptop, log in with these credentials:

Username: `cechuser` **Password:** `Pa$$w0rd`

Step 3: First ARP Check

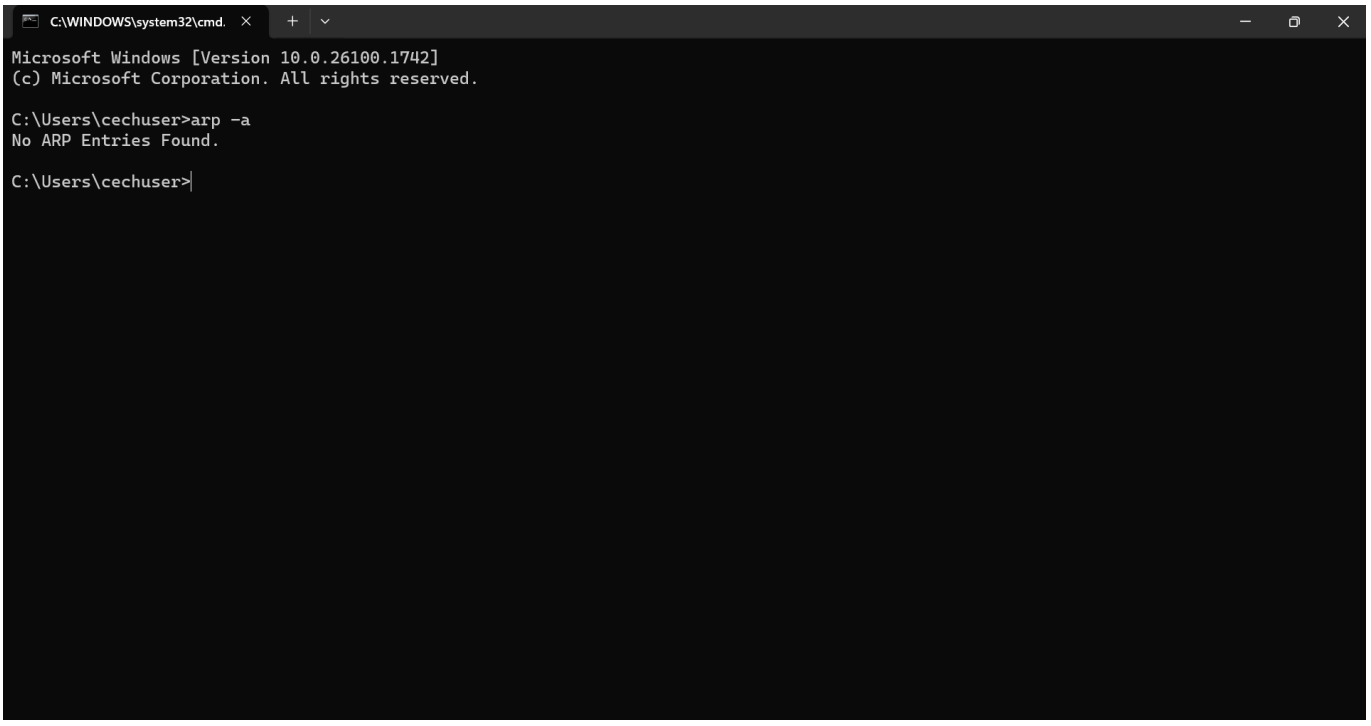
Before connecting the laptop into the network, run the first `arp` command:

Press `Windows + R`, type `cmd`, and press Enter:



Run:

```
arp -a
```



You should not see any learned entries for the lab's switch or server.

> [!NOTE] ARP (Address Resolution Protocol) helps your computer match IPv4 addresses with physical addresses (MAC addresses). Before your laptop can send data to another device on the LAN, it has to learn that device's MAC address. It does this using the **Address Resolution Protocol (ARP)**.

Part 2 - Deploy Your Network

Step 4: Connect Your Equipment

1. Position your deployment bag at your workstation
2. Connect your laptop to its assigned switch port using an Ethernet cable
3. Verify that all equipment is turned on and the Ethernet link lights are active.

Laptop Assignments:

Switch	Port 1	Port 2	Port 3
SW01	PC01	PC02	PC03
SW02	PC04	PC05	PC06
SW03	PC07	PC08	PC09
SW04	PC10	PC11	PC12

> [!IMPORTANT] Do not connect your deployment bag to UC's production network or any classroom wall Ethernet outlet. Do not modify switch or server configurations.

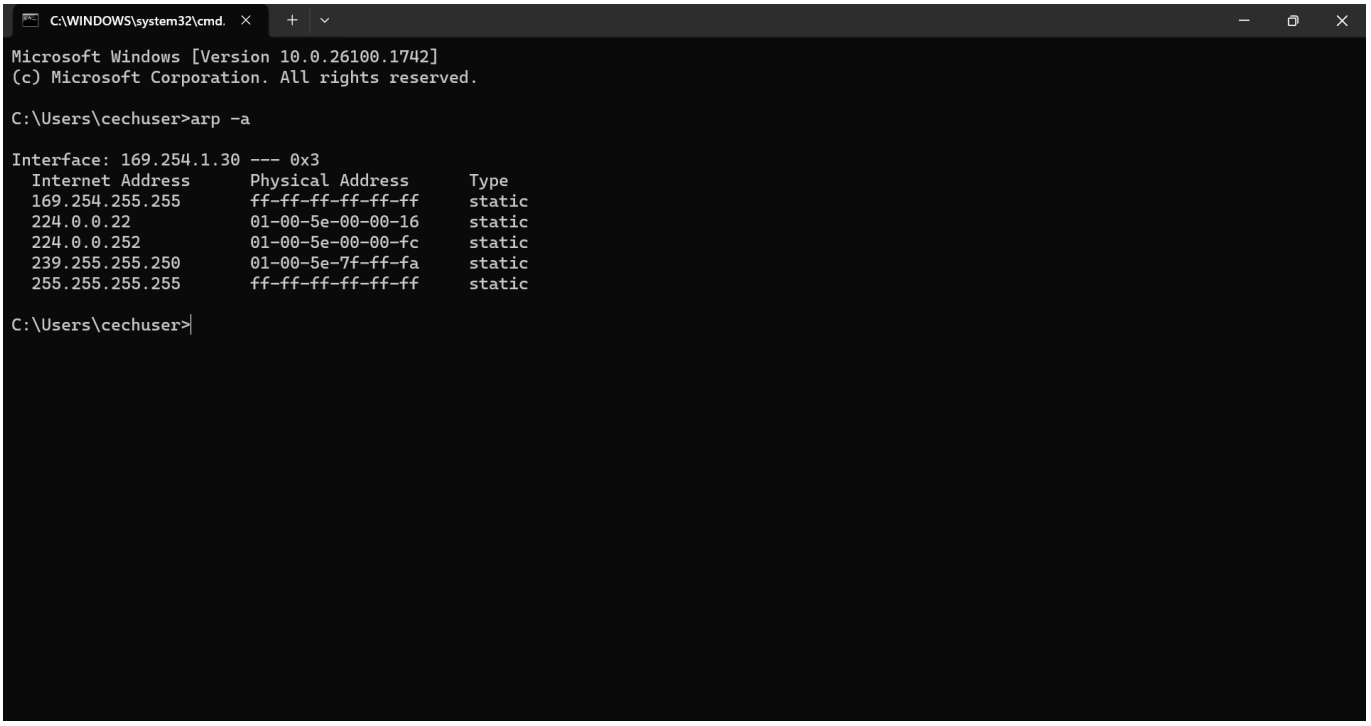
Step 5: Check ARP Again

Run:

```
arp -a
```

You should still see no learned entries for the switch or server. You may see basic system entries populate. This is okay.

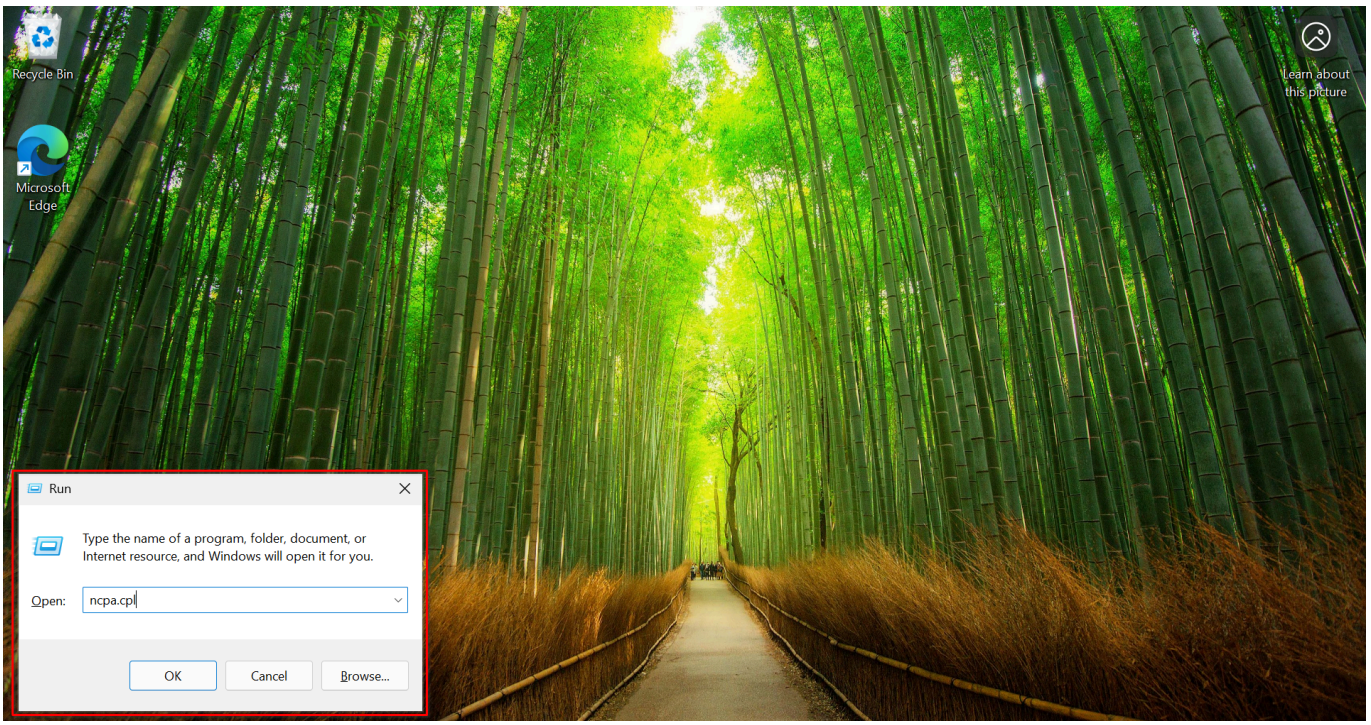
Your laptop is physically connected, but it hasn't been configured to communicate on the lab's IPv4 network.



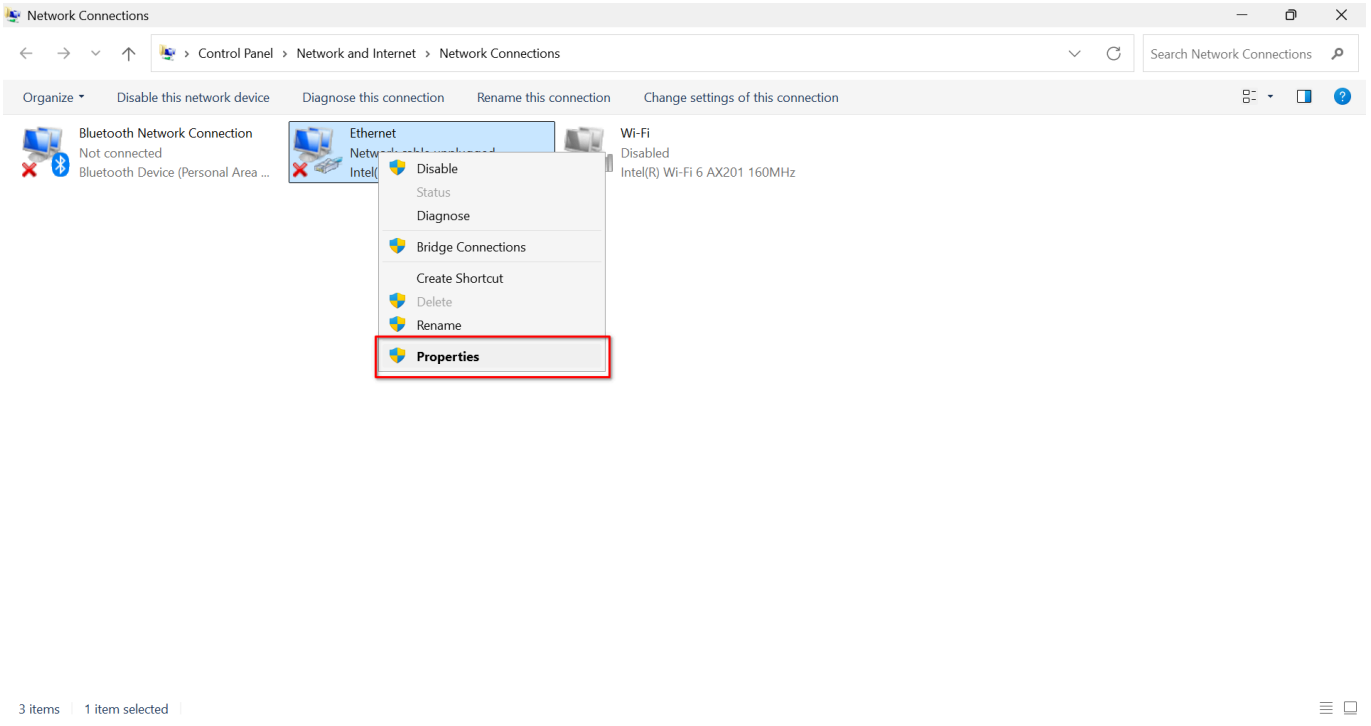
Part 3 - Configure Your Laptop

Step 6: Assign IPv4 Address

Press `Windows + R`, type `ncpa.cpl`, press Enter:

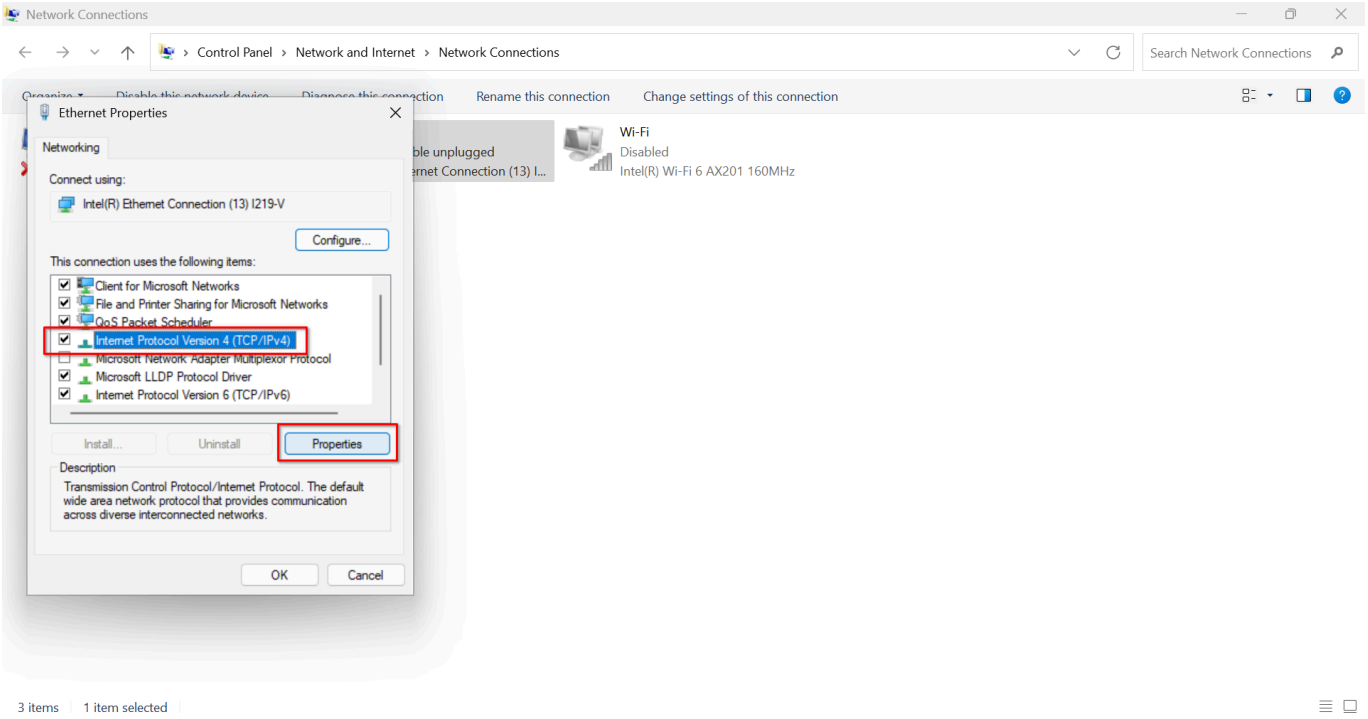


Right click `Ethernet` and select `Properties`:



You will be **prompted to enter your password** in order to enter privileged mode. Enter the same login password, `Pa$$w0rd`.

Select `Internet Protocol Version 4 (TCP/IPv4)`, and then `Properties`:



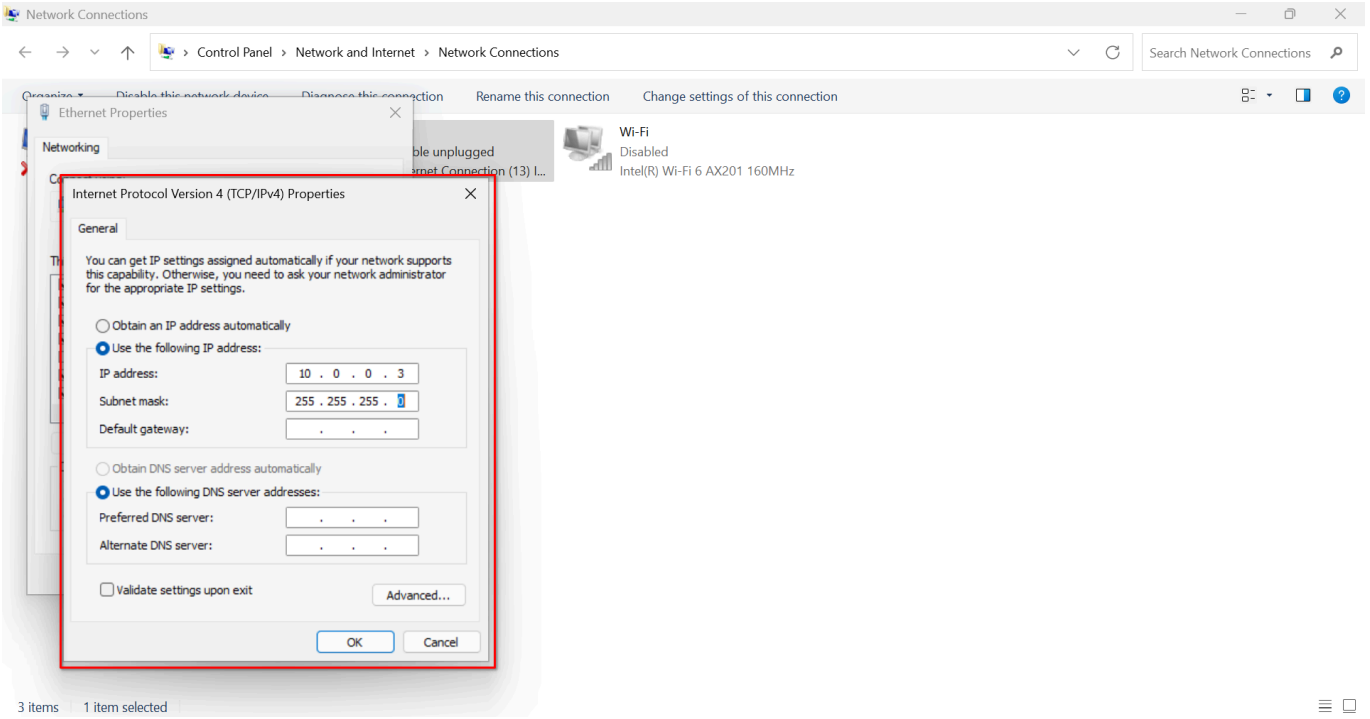
Choose `Use the following IP address`. **Enter the IP address corresponding to your *assigned switch port*:**

Switch Port	IPv4 Address
1	10.0.0.3
2	10.0.0.4
3	10.0.0.5

Use these additional settings:

Setting	Value
Subnet mask	255.255.255.0
Default Gateway	*Leave blank*
DNS servers	*Leave blank*

Click **OK** to save your changes.



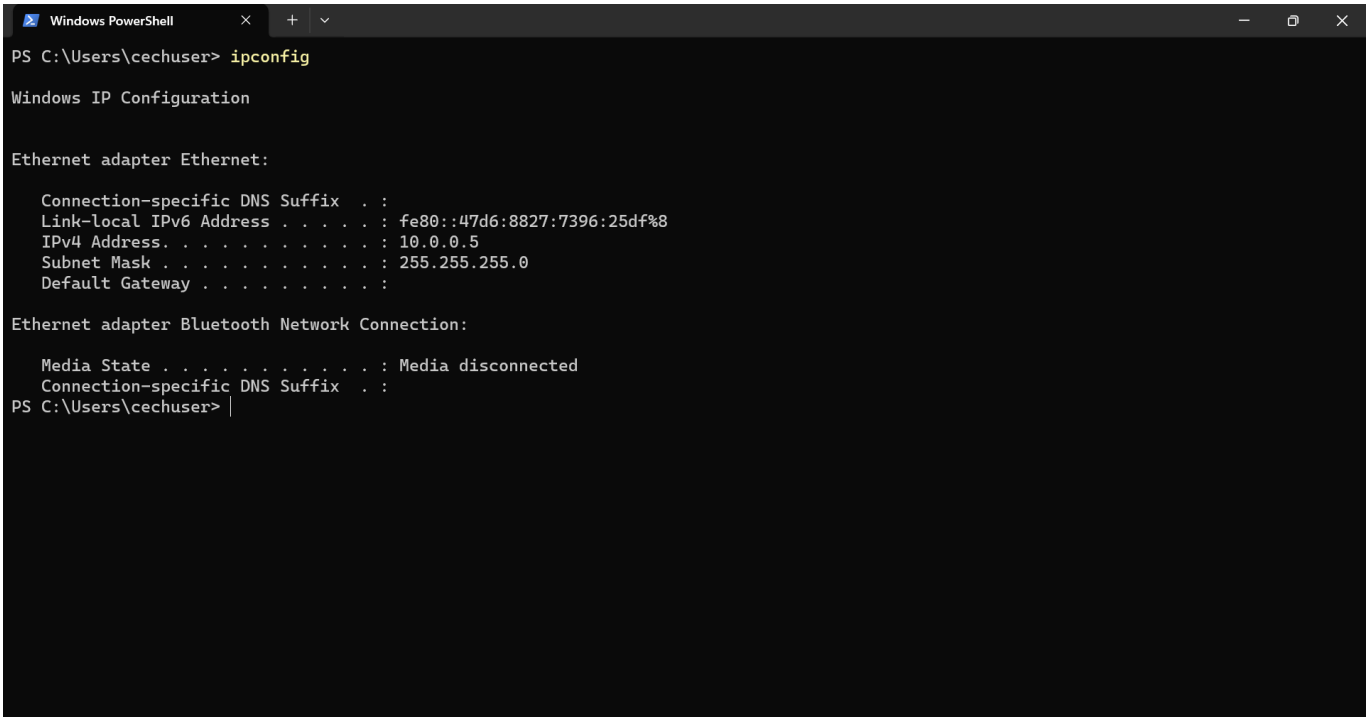
Step 7: Verify IPv4 Configuration

Return to Command Prompt and run:

```
ipconfig
```

Confirm that your Ethernet adapter displays the correct IPv4 address and subnet mask.

Your laptop now has an IPv4 address, but you haven't intentionally communicated with either device yet.



Part 4 - Test Your Network

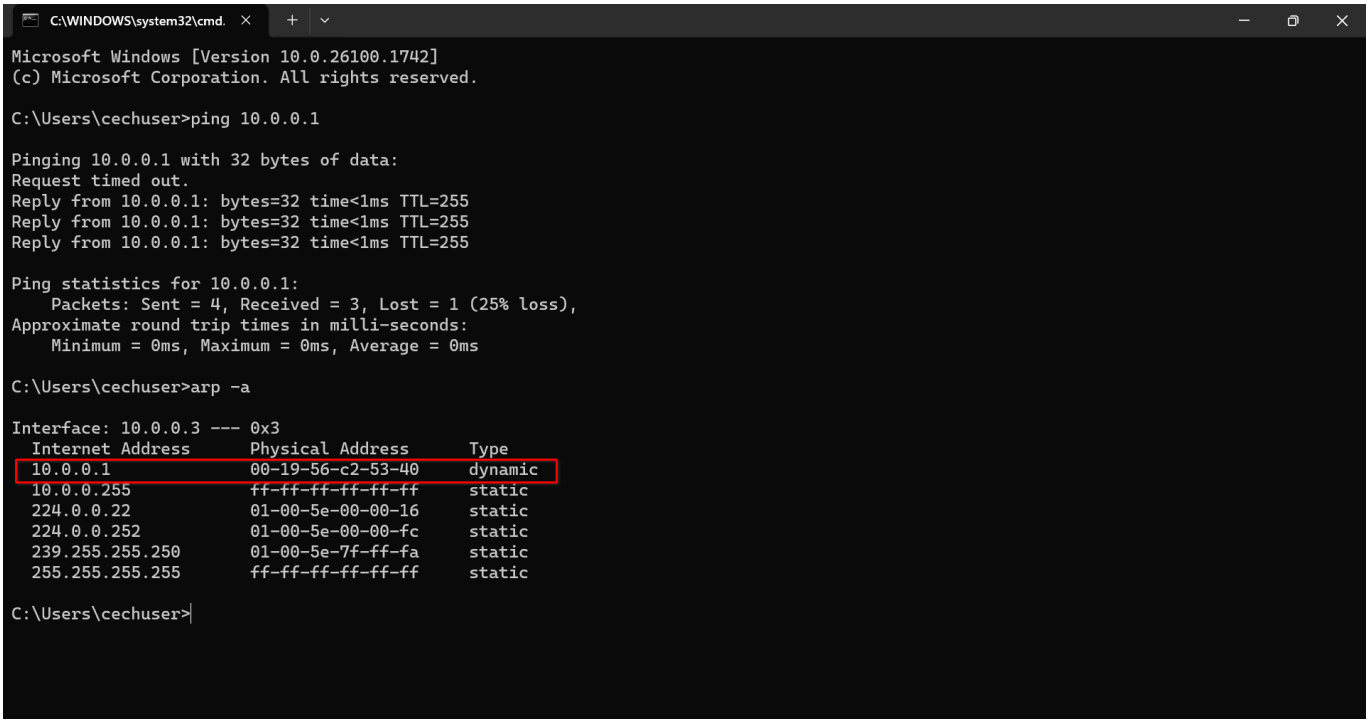
Step 8: Ping the Switch

Run:

```
ping 10.0.0.1

arp -a
```

You should receive replies from the switch. After the ARP command, the table should populate with the address for the switch.



Why Can You Ping this Switch?

In Packet Tracer, you previously worked with switches that didn't have an IP address configured.

Those switches could forward network traffic, but you couldn't ping the switches themselves.

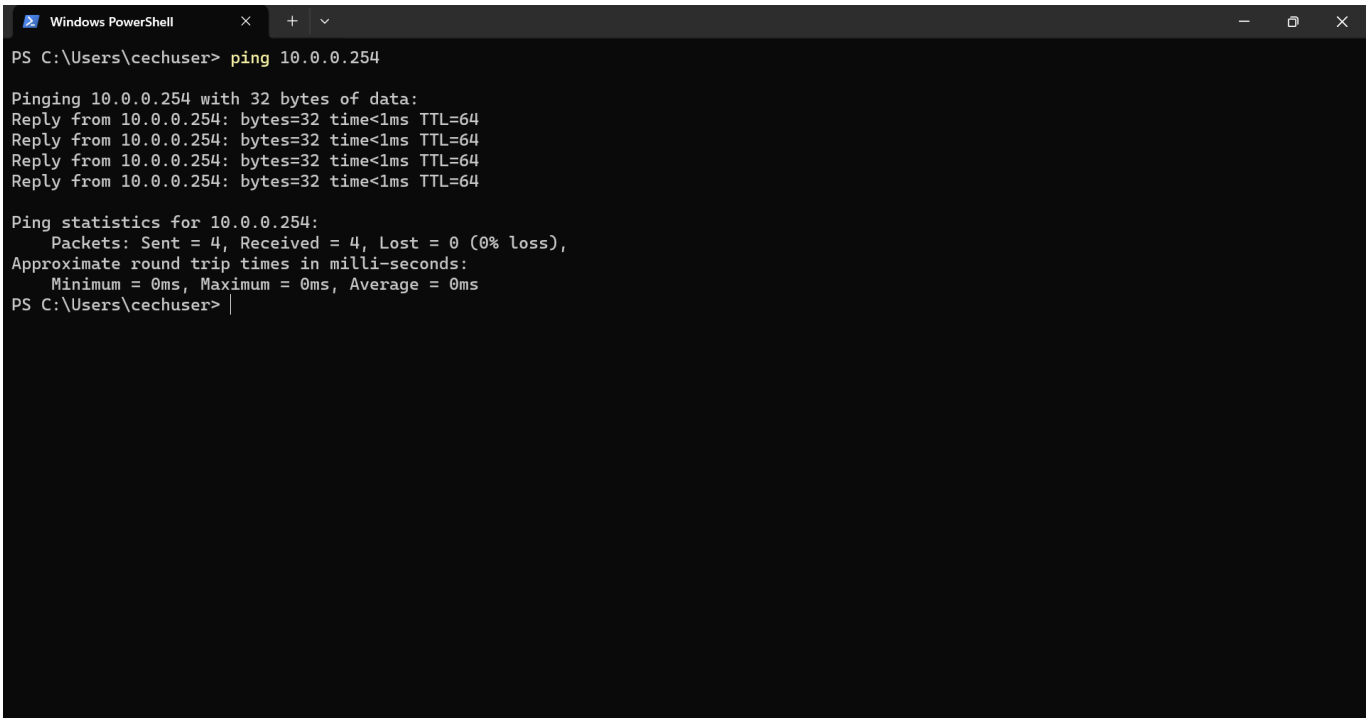
This lab uses a managed switch with its own IP address (10.0.0.1). This allows you to communicate with the switch directly.

Step 9: Ping the Server

Run:

```
ping 10.0.0.254
```

You should receive replies from the Raspberry Pi.



Step 10: Check ARP One Last Time

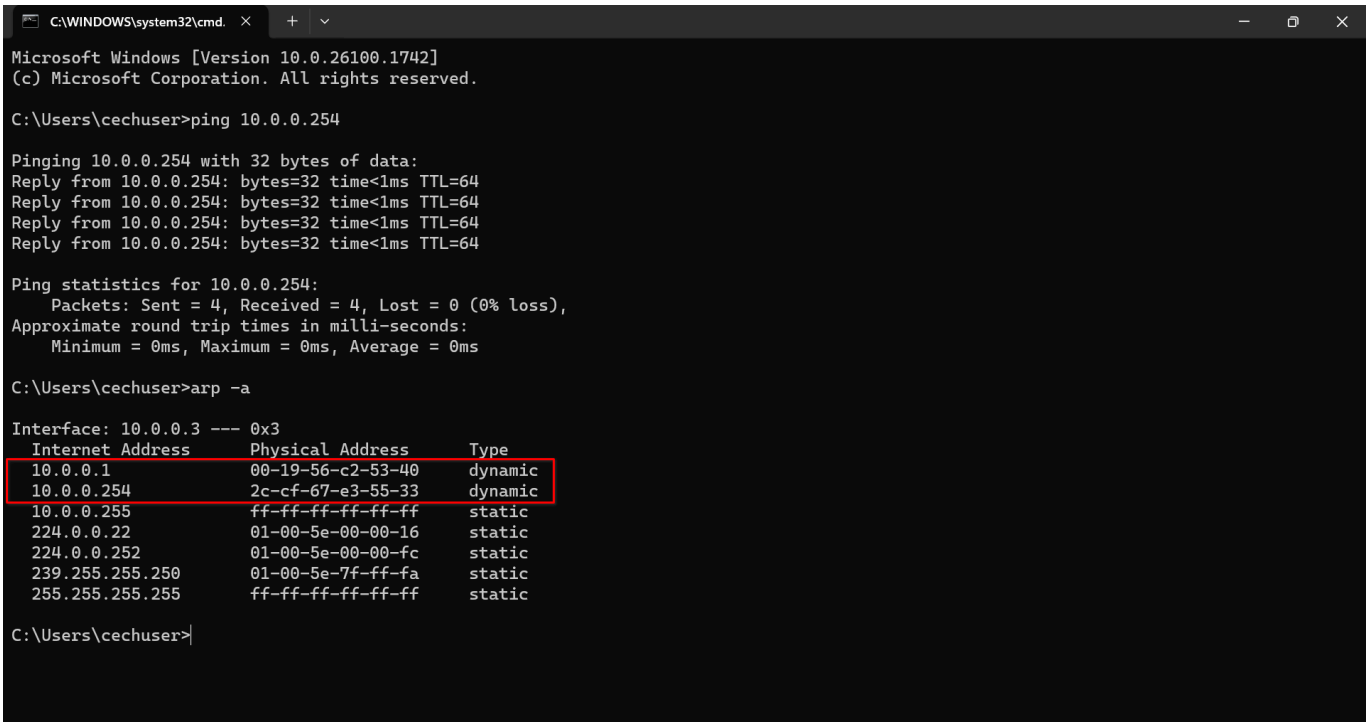
Run:

```
arp -a
```

You should now see entries similar to these:

Internet Address	Physical Address
10.0.0.1	Switch MAC Address
10.0.0.254	Server MAC Address

Your laptop *used ARP to discover the MAC addresses* needed to communicate with these devices.



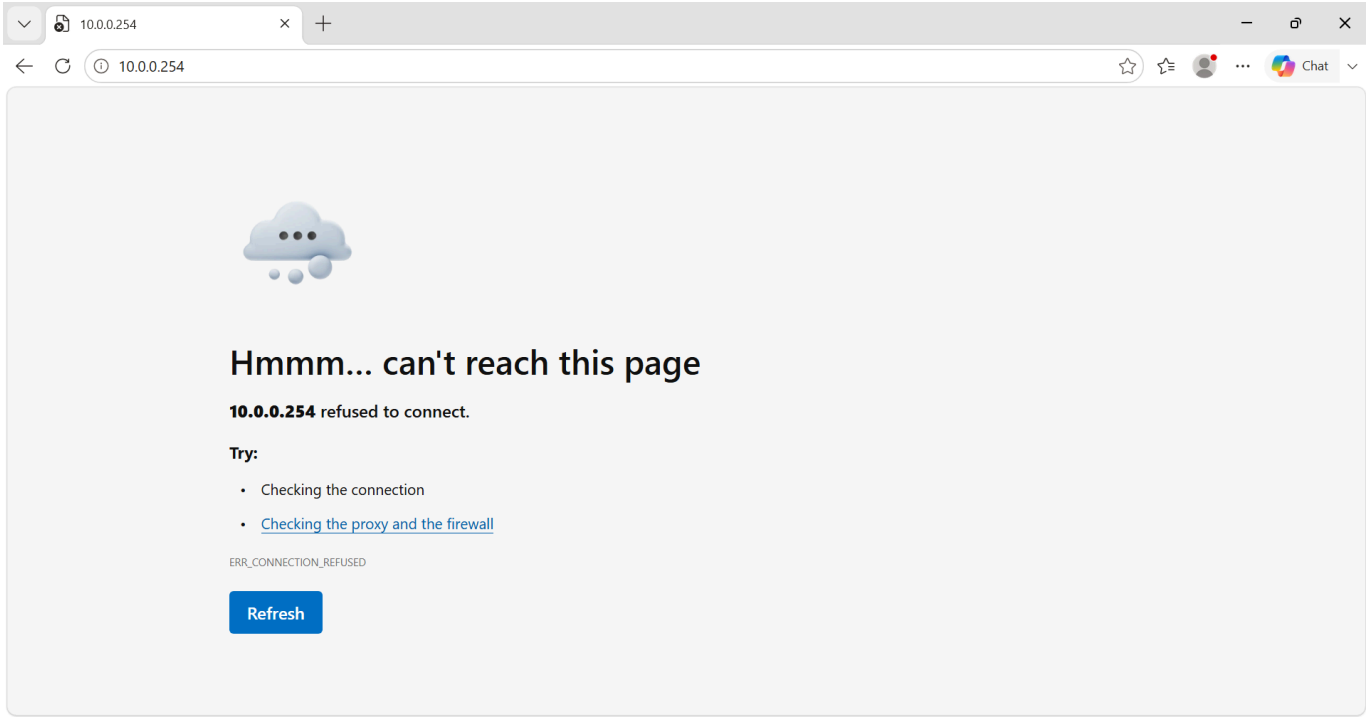
Part 5 - Connect to lan-games

Step 11: Open the Server

Open your web browser and enter:

```
http://10.0.0.254
```

What happens?



Your browser uses port 80 by default for HTTP, but **LAN Games is running on a different port**.

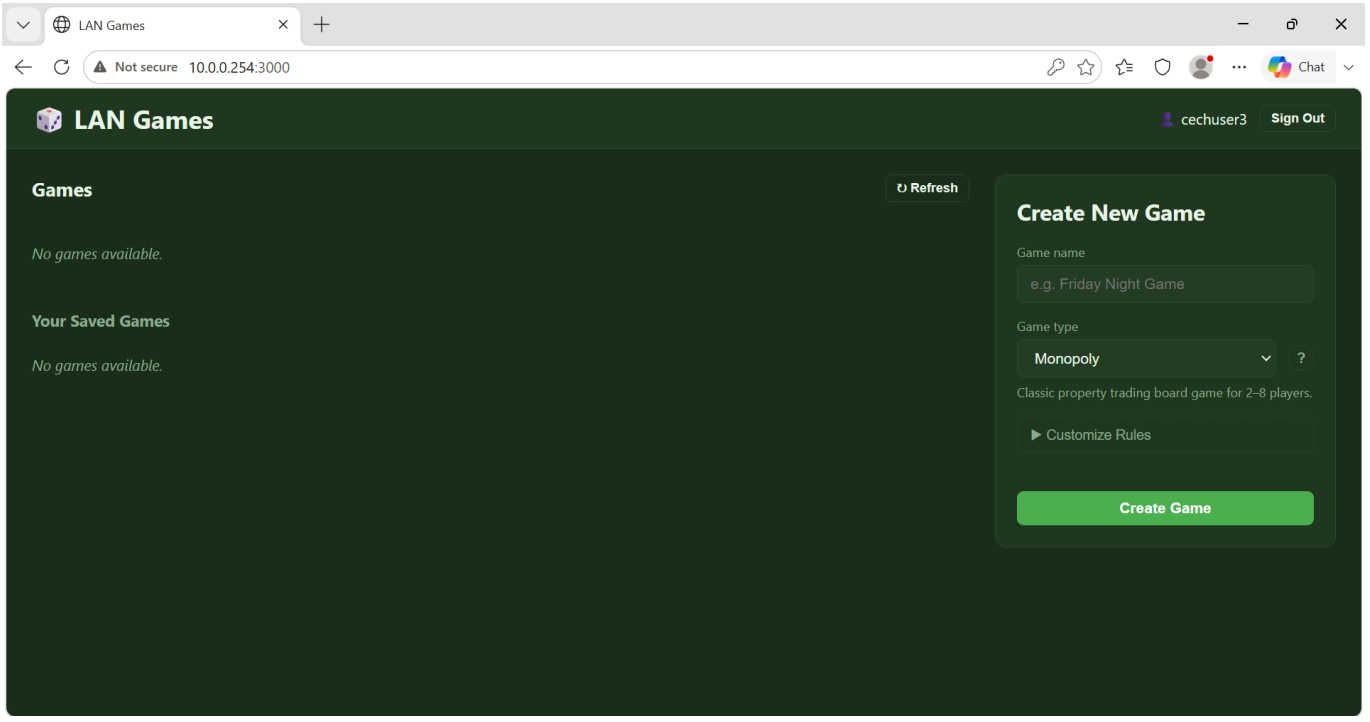
Step 12: Find the Right Port

Now enter:

```
http://10.0.0.254:3000
```

You should see the LAN Games homepage!

The IP address identifies the server. The port number (3000) identifies the service you want to access.



Part 6 - Submit & Play

Step 13: Complete the Quiz

On your **personal laptop**:

1. Open Canvas
2. Find the Lab 01 lan-games quiz
3. Answer both questions and submit

Step 14: Game Time

Once you've submitted your quiz, you're free to play LAN Games with your classmates for the remainder of the class.

You've successfully deployed, configured, and tested a physical local area network.

Step 15: Clean-up Checklist

- ☐ Close your browser and command-line windows.

- [ ] Unplug power adapters, then Ethernet cables.
- [ ] Coil cables loosely and return everything to your bag.
- [ ] Change your laptop's IPv4 setting back to **Automatic (DHCP)**